METHODS PAPER / 2026 / SHOWCASE EDITION

A framework for cataloguing regional formations

Geo-Kurdistan collections team

Geological collections | Kurdistan Region

Review status: Pending teacher review. This mock editorial publication supports teacher feedback on the showcase. It is not a published scientific study.

Abstract

A proposed public-facing structure for connecting names, ages, descriptions, places, media and references.

01 / Why a public formation record needs structure

A formation page must connect a recognized geological name with lithology, age, mapped occurrence, characteristic exposures and references. It should also distinguish verified statements from provisional showcase content.

The visitor interface starts with the facts needed for orientation, then reveals context, evidence and citations progressively.



Rawandiz Canyon · field context

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02 / Names, ages and local expressions

A formation name is not simply a category label. The same unit can look different across its mapped extent, and visually similar cliffs may belong to different units. The catalogue therefore avoids identification from appearance alone.

Age terminology should be understandable to general visitors while preserving the reviewed scientific wording used by specialists.

03 / Connecting records without fixing a database

The showcase relates formations to rocks, fossils, places and research through explicit reasons such as same locality or host context. These labels help teachers evaluate which relationships are meaningful before any final database schema is designed.



Ridge-scale expression of resistant strata

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04 / Editorial review and change

Every published claim should carry a clear source and review status. The current content model is intentionally replaceable so teacher feedback can change terminology, required fields and category boundaries without redesigning the experience.

References and editorial limits

Prototype scope

Information-architecture proposal for teacher review; not a regional stratigraphic authority.